PAGAD, sharpened boundaries between the Muslim community and "others," including divisions between Muslims and Jews. Relations between the latter were further strained by PAGAD's flaunting of links with Hamas and Hizballah. According to Esack this was "misplaced bluster and bravado" rather than "strategic earnestness," but it was indicative of psychological connections to the universal Muslim community (the *ummah*) and an attempt to identify "with those living in situations of injustice."[22] This outlook helped towards consolidating a powerful anti-Zionism, assisted by what Muslims (and others) saw as comparisons between the apartheid state and oppression in Palestine.[23]

The Muslim community was increasingly "hot-wired" to events in the Middle East. Thus the infamous "pig poster" incident in Hebron, Israel, led to heated protests in Pretoria and Cape Town and the firebombing of a Jewish Book Center. The hostile mood was exacerbated by the breakdown in the Israeli-Palestinian Oslo peace process. In the context of such tensions, Qibla led protests at the Israeli Jubilee celebrations in Cape Town, and the Secretary General of the Muslim Judicial Council, Sheikh Achmat Sedick, claimed that it was appalling for any South African to share in these Jewish and Zionist celebrations.[24] The mood was further inflamed when the South African government refused to issue a visa to Sheik Ahmed Yassin, spiritual leader of Hamas, who nevertheless conducted a telephone interview that was broadcast on a Cape Town Muslim radio station.[25] Protests followed with marchers outside parliament chanting the usual "Death to Israel" and "One Zionist, one bullet," while an Israeli flag was burnt.[26]

Holocaust denial has also crept into Muslim anger. In 1996, Radio 786, a Muslim radio station, had to apologize for airing an interview with Dr. Ahmed Huber, who spoke of the "Holocaust swindle." In May 1998, the same radio station interviewed Dr. Yaqub Zaki who, besides claiming that the "million plus" Jews who died in the Second World War had died of infectious diseases, spent much of his time engaged with elaborate Jewish conspiracies. *Muslim News* also peddled denial literature shortly after the Cape Town Holocaust Centre was opened in 1998.[27]

A second major element in South African hostility to Zionism has been the "Third Worldist" and pro-Palestinian ANC-led sentiment fuelled by the close ties that existed between apartheid South Africa and Israel from the early 1970s onwards. This is coupled with a visceral suspicion of ethnicity that challenges the notion of an "ethnic state" and frames the Israel-Palestinian struggle through a South African prism. Black intellectuals deem the notion of a Jewish State to be "exclusivist" and its foundation "colonialist." To be sure, the ANC (together with the Indian Congress, the Coloured People's

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,